

HOUSE JOINT RESOLUTION 145

By Hemmer

A RESOLUTION to honor the memory of Representative Richard "Dick" Russwurm Clark, Sr., of Nashville.

WHEREAS, we were greatly saddened to learn of the passing of our former colleague, Representative Richard "Dick" Russwurm Clark, Sr., of Nashville, a prominent Tennessean who believed strongly in the power of service and dedication; and

WHEREAS, an eleven-term member of the House of Representatives, Dick Clark ably represented the good people of the Antioch community in Davidson County during his illustrious tenure in the General Assembly, which spanned the 88th through 98th General Assemblies; and

WHEREAS, first elected in 1972, Representative Clark worked tirelessly in support of the working man and his fellow citizens with mental illness and addiction problems; and

WHEREAS, Representative Clark was one of the most influential pro-labor legislators during his twenty-two-year tenure, and his commitment to public service ensured his legacy as a leader who worked with integrity and compassion; and

WHEREAS, Dick Clark enlisted in the U.S. Marine Corps after graduating from high school and served admirably until a genetic eye disease forced his discharge; and

WHEREAS, upon returning home to Nashville, Representative Clark married his high school sweetheart, Sharon, and the couple built a happy home while he worked his way through Middle Tennessee State University as an undergraduate and then Nashville School of Law, from which he earned his juris doctorate; and

WHEREAS, as an attorney, Representative Clark focused on labor issues; no matter the difficulty of the case at hand, he never allowed his limited vision to prevent him from effectively representing his client; and

WHEREAS, after his political and legal careers ended, Dick Clark played an instrumental role in establishing Foundations Clinic and Dual Diagnosis Management with his partners and friends, Bob Nash and Mike Cartwright; and

WHEREAS, through his work with the clinic, he was a fierce advocate for people suffering from mental illness and addiction; and

WHEREAS, Mr. Clark's family was his greatest joy, and he took great pride in their accomplishments while cherishing their happiness; and

WHEREAS, Dick Clark is survived by his brother, Jerry Clark; his former wife of thirty-five years and the mother of his six children, Sharon Clark; his current wife, Deborah Clark; six children; twenty grandchildren; and nine great-grandchildren; and

WHEREAS, he was preceded in death by his parents, the late Beaula Mae Clark and William "Bill" Clark, and his sister, Billie Ann Abrams; and

WHEREAS, Representative Clark touched many lives through his wisdom and commitment to making Tennessee an even better place; and

WHEREAS, for twenty-two years, Dick Clark was a vital member of this body, and his passing leaves a void in his community and this State that will not be easily filled; now, therefore,

BE IT RESOLVED BY THE HOUSE OF REPRESENTATIVES OF THE ONE HUNDRED FOURTEENTH GENERAL ASSEMBLY OF THE STATE OF TENNESSEE, THE SENATE CONCURRING, that we honor the memory of our former colleague Representative Richard "Dick" Russwurm Clark, Sr., reflecting fondly upon his numerous contributions to good government in Tennessee, his advocacy for the labor force as an attorney and legislator, and his legacy of effective public service in his community.

BE IT FURTHER RESOLVED, that we express our sympathy and extend our condolences to Representative Clark's family and many friends.

BE IT FURTHER RESOLVED, that an appropriate copy of this resolution be prepared for presentation with this final clause omitted from such copy and upon proper request made to the appropriate clerk, the language appearing immediately following the State seal appear without House or Senate designation.